Canary Media - Clean Energy News Aggregation Generated: August 19, 2025 at 09:22 PM Source: https://www.canarymedia.com/rss.rss Total Articles: 3 --- ## Come to America and lose 1B: Trump drives more offshore wind pain **Published: August 19, 2025 **URL:** https://www.canarymedia.com/articles/offshore-wind/orsted-financial-struggles-trump-revolution-sunrise Europe's largest wind energy company was brought to its knees last week by a market it helped create. Ørsted, the Danish energy giant thatconstructed the first wind turbinesin U.S. federal waters just five years ago, needs $9.4billion to complete its two remaining U.S. offshore wind projects and to continue to be financially sound enough to build wind farms elsewhere — likely in places far away from the United States. During its Aug.11earnings call, Ørsted blamed its funding needs on "adverse developments" in the U.S. market, referring to the political risk, red tape, and tax credit changes created in recent months by Trump administration policies. Ørsted's investor presentation described theseMAGAheadwinds as "unexpected developments outside our control." The announcement follows a series of setbacks for foreign offshore wind developers that were once seen as essential to fulfilling the decarbonization goals set by the U.S. government and many Northeastern states. In January, the U.K.'s Shellexitedthe now-defunct**

Atlantic Shores wind project slated for the waters near New Jersey,absorbing a $996million loss. In late July, Norway's Equinor announced a$955million impairmentfrom unexpected changes and delays to its Empire Wind project, which President Donald Trump tried —and failed— to cancel. Though intensified by the current administration, the industry's financial troubles began even before Trump took office. One year ago, Ørstedannounced a $575million impairmentdue in part to delays on its704-megawatt Revolution Wind project near Rhode Island. Two years ago, it booked a more than$5billion impairmentfrom its scrapped Ocean Wind1and2projects off New Jersey's coastline. "'Come to America and lose a billion dollars' should be the headline of your article," said Elizabeth Wilson, a wind energy expert and professor of environmental studies at Dartmouth College, in an interview with Canary Media. Denmark, which owns half of Ørsted, is backing the new fundraising effort in which the company will issue new shares worth about45% its total value. It's a fallback plan resulting from Ørsted's failure to sell part of its ownership stake in Sunrise Wind, a924-megawatt wind farm under construction near Long Island, New York. The project is more than one-third of the way built and is slated for completion by the end of2027, but no one wanted to buy into it at a workable price. Selling

off a stake of Sunrise Wind was always part of the plan; the proceeds were meant to cover a large chunk of its construction. Now that would-be buyers are avoiding Trump's chaos, Ørsted is left footing the entire bill. The firm's other active U.S. project, Revolution Wind, is80% complete and is expected to be fully operational by the second half of2026, the company announced during the call. But despite assurances that both Revolution Wind and Sunrise Wind will be finished, even at a steep cost to the firm, Ørsted — according to Wilson — is unlikely to invest in American offshore wind again. Ørsted did not respond to a request for comment by publication time. "What developers really need is market certainty," said Wilson, who wasn't surprised that Ørsted could not find a buyer for Sunrise Wind. Trump's presidency has brought too much risk, she explained. Trumpissued an executive orderon Inauguration Day that froze all offshore wind permitting and leasing pending a federal review. Seemingly safe at the time were eight projects, including Ørsted's Sunrise Wind and Revolution Wind, that already had all their federal permits in hand. Of those fully permitted projects,the2.8-gigawatt Atlantic Shores projectoff the New Jersey coast has since fallen apart. Two more arelikely to be mothballed— MarWin near Maryland and New England Wind off the Massachusetts coastline

— since they probably won’t qualify for the wind-energy tax credits thatTrump’s July megabillsent to an early grave. Trump did not kickstart the sector’s problems — he simply poured gasoline on the fire. Thefinancial struggles offshore wind developers facedin2023and2024were caused not by political headwinds, but instead by inflation, high interest rates, pandemic-related supply chain issues, and the U.S.’slengthy approval processfor new projects compared to Europe or Asia. Beyond Ørsted and Equinor, other foreign developers likeBPand Avangrid alsocanceled or attempted to renegotiatecontracts during this time. By fall2023,it was already clearthat the industry would struggle to meet the Biden administration’s ambitious goal of building30gigawatts of offshore wind capacity by2030— a target that helped spark the rush of European investment into U.S. wind lease auctions and projects. Analysts at BloombergNEF predicted at the time thatjust16.4GWwould be builtby the decade’s end. Soon after Trump took office, Barbara Kates-Garnick, a professor of energy policy at Tufts University, told Canary Media that America would fall short of5GWof offshore wind power generation— less than20% of former President Joe Biden’s original goal. Now, with major European wind developers losing billions and looking for the door, reaching even that figure will be an achievement. Clare Fieseler, PhD, is a reporter at Canary Media covering offshore wind. Distributed energy resources --- ## Colorado now requires health warning labels on gas stoves **Published:** August 19, 2025 **URL:** https://www.canarymedia.com/articles/fossil-fuels/colorado-gas-stove-health-warning-labels Mounting evidence shows that gas stoves — used innearly40% of U.S. homes— pose serious health risks. Now, Coloradans have a new tool to learn about the dangers of cooking with little blue flames. Gas stoves sold in the state will need a yellow health-warning label under afirst-in-the-nation lawthat went into effect earlier this month. “It’s fair to warn people, especially if they have health impacts from [poor] air quality, to know what they’re buying in advance,” said state Sen. Cathy Kipp, a Democrat who cosponsored the legislation. Likeother gas-burning appliancesand gasoline-burning cars, gas ranges spew noxious compounds such as carbon monoxide and nitrogen oxides. Even off, they emit benzene, a potent carcinogen found in secondhand cigarette smoke; breathing in the fumes from gas rangesincreases the risk of cancer, especially in kids. Children in homes with gas stoves are also estimated to be42% more likely to develop asthma. “We know that this information has not been reaching the

public at the point of sale," said Kirsten Schatz, public advocate at the nonprofit CoPIRG Foundation. Since the1970s, fossil-fuel companies havecited industry-backed research and hired scientiststo discount evidence that gas stoves cause harm, according to an investigation byNPR. In2024, the U.S. gas-stove market was estimated at$3.8billion. In a2022survey of retail stores in10states, public advocacy group U.S.PIRG, affiliated with CoPIRG, found that most salespeople said they wereunaware of the health risks of gas stoves. Manufacturers have thrown up a hurdle to the new rules; they've asked the federal district court in Colorado to freeze the law's enforcement. Violators would normally face an up to $20,000fine, but on Wednesday, the state's attorney general agreed not to enforce the rules until the court reaches a decision, according to Abe Scarr, energy and utilities program director atPIRG. Though Colorado is the first state to mandate warning labels,MassachusettsandNew Yorkcould be next. Last year,proposals in Illinois and Californiaboth failed, though the Golden State got close; ultimately, Gov. Gavin Newsom (D)vetoed the bill. Colorado's new requirements follow other policies — frombuilding ordinancestoperformance standardstoair-quality regulations— adopted at state and municipal levels to rein in the sale of

gas equipment. More than70local governmentsare ensuring gas appliances aren't installed in most new buildings by requiring new construction to be all-electric. In July, New Yorkbecame the first state to codify such rules. Under Colorado's law, gas-stove warning labels need to bear the phrase, "Understand the air quality implications of having an indoor gas stove." The stickers will have aURLlink orQRcode that directs curious consumers to astate webpage. Colorado requires that the site, created and maintained by its Department of Public Health and Environment, provides "credible, evidence-based information on the health impacts of gas-fueled stoves." The warnings only need to be displayed on floor models or the website on which they're being sold, Kipp said. "We made it really simple for manufacturers to comply," she added, but still, "they just don't want to do it." Ina federal lawsuitfiled Aug.5, the Association of Home Appliance Manufacturers alleges that Colorado is compelling its members to endorse a warning label that directs consumers to "non-consensus, scientifically controversial, and factually misleading" information. In doing so, the industry group continues, the state is violating its members' First Amendment rights "to be free from … unconstitutional compelled speech." "The lawsuit is frivolous," Kipp said. "It's well within the authority of our Colorado

legislature to pass laws that implement consumer protections.” While appliance makers are portraying the science as unsettled, “that’s not true,” Kipp said. Several nonpartisan nonprofit organizations recognize the large body of peer-reviewed research on gas-stove pollution and have voiced support for warning labels, Schatz said, including theAmerican Public Health Association,American Lung Association,American Medical Association, andAmerican Thoracic Society. The parties to the lawsuit are asking for a hearing to be scheduled in early November, Scarr said. They’ve also agreed to a deposition — sworn testimony outside the courtroom — of any witness whom appliance manufacturers rely on to make their case. “This litigation is set to become a battle of the experts regarding the health impacts of gas stoves,” Scarr said. “Given the science, we’re confident the state can win.” Alison F. Takemurais staff writer at Canary Media. She reports on home electrification, building decarbonization strategies, and the clean energy workforce. Distributed energy resources --- ## Cruising Virginia countryside in an electric vehicle is a lot easier now **Published:** August 19, 2025 **URL:** https://www.canarymedia.com/articles/ev-charging/middleburg-virginia-fast-charger-tourism But the roughly80-mile stretch of U.S. Route50that snakes across Virginia from the

nation's capital to the West Virginia border is rich in American history and culture. The mostly two-lane, winding mountain road features vineyards, battlefields, high-end resorts, and more. And just like the iconic route from Chicago to California, U.S.50is increasingly making way for the future of American road trips: electric vehicles. The tiny town of Middleburg, Virginia, is a case in point: Officials there installed a fast charger nearly18months ago to serveEVdrivers in the wealthy, bucolic region just45miles west of Washington, D.C. Named for its equidistance between Alexandria and Winchester, Middleburg has long been at the center of foxhunting and steeplechases. These days, the town of less than1,000people is also surrounded by wineries and boasts afilm festival,a168-room five-star resort, and a Christmas parade replete withhorses and hound dogs. "Since colonial times it has been a stopping place, and it's continued to be a place where people come from all over the world, as well as from the greater D.C. area," said Lynne Kaye, chair of Middleburg's sustainability committee. As electric vehicles have become more prevalent, so too has "EVtourism": towns off the beaten path seeking tolure travelers with charging infrastructure. While visitors juice up — often for free at relatively slow Level2chargers – they might

browse local art galleries and shops, grab some dinner, or visit another attraction they may have otherwise missed. But Middleburg is part of Loudoun County,the nation's richest, with some of themost robustEVadoption numbers in Virginia. The town has ample attractions, so the idea to install a charger was less about drawing in new visitors than it was about keeping those already passing through happy. "When we walked around town, we were noticing a bunch of EVs," said Kaye. "We wanted to make sure that we didn't accidentally become unappealing to people who were driving them." Reducing the town's climate footprint was also a consideration. Kaye and others reason that cars driven by visitors and residents are the leading contributor to its planet-warming emissions. "We only have673residents. We can only create so much carbon," she said. "But when you have20,000people come to an event, that's a lot of carbon all at once." When town leaders were in the planning stages of adding their charger, they also noticed a lack of devices in the region that could fill up a car battery in an hour or less. "Not everybody wants to spend however many hours getting theirEVcharged," Kaye said. For all these reasons, the decision to install a fast charger in the heart of town was an easy one. But bringing that choice to fruition wasn't as simple. An expansive bay with10or more chargers, an

increasingly common feature at gas stations, wasn't logistically feasible in the tiny Town Hall parking lot. And most charging companies Middleburg approached wanted to install no fewer than six fast chargers. "Getting this huge bank of chargers didn't fit a historic town," Kaye said. "There wasn't really space for it, and we weren't sure that we were going to get enough traffic to use the chargers effectively."
XCharge North America came to the rescue. The charger manufacturer was "willing to work with us and come up with a way to have the one charger," Kaye said. "And it's been a success."
Initially called Current Electric, the startup had recently been acquired by a European equipment maker. Its business proposition:making fast chargers cheaperby using a208-volt system rather than the global standard of480V. While Middleburg had already wired its new Town Hall to accommodate the industry standard, XCharge still leapt at the opportunity to showcase its hardware, said company cofounder Alex Urist. "This was very much a way for us to get early applications in the U.S.," said Urist, who lives in New York City. "The proximity to D.C. is great as well. Selfishly, I go to D.C. to visit the in-laws frequently enough, so I can always check in on the charger. I like to take them over there and show off that I actually have a job," he quipped.
Typical direct-current fast-charging units can

run between $30,000and $120,000. In Middleburg's case, XCharge provided its hardware for free while the town covered the installation. The two entities share the revenue from charging sessions, and the company can learn from how the fast charger performs as it explores other markets. "It's not really a charger on a high-throughput area," Urist said. "But what is interesting about it is, it's kind of dead in the middle of Virginia wine country. It's along this rural corridor where the perceptive availability of chargers is very important." Between March2024, when the charger was installed, and February2025,181sessions were logged. Since then, there's been an uptake, with268sessions logged as of May2025, according to XCharge. "It's a really interesting use case for us to see. How does it help with the local economy? Are they going to also see any ancillary impacts of it beyond just the revenue coming in?" Urist said. Indeed, that's one of the expectations behind an initiative called Virginia Green Travel, which helps the state's towns, especially those with carbon-reduction goals, attract environmentally minded tourists, said Alleyn Harned, executive director of Virginia Clean Cities. "Electric vehicle chargers have been part of green tourism in Virginia," said Harned, whose group is among the backers of the Green Travel initiative. Virginia Clean Cities,

a U.S. Department of Energy-funded entity that's based at James Madison University in Harrisonburg, is what brought Middleburg and XCharge together. The town's success with its fast charger was a bright spot for the organization after President Donald Trumpstalled the rolloutof $5billion for charging infrastructure launched under his predecessor. "This is a positive story in getting something done," Harned said, "because this stuff really improves our economy." As the Trump administration moves towardreleasing National Electric Vehicle Infrastructure fundsafter losses in court, more towns across Virginia may have the chance to follow Middleburg's lead. Kaye says they should know that fast charging is possible for them. "I think it's important for other small towns to realize that there is an opportunity, if they want to take it," she said. Elizabeth Ouztsis a contributing reporter at Canary Media who covers North Carolina and Virginia. Distributed energy resources ---